

UNOFFICIAL PLAYER'S COMPANION

Don't Miss a Thing

Missables · Endings · Gwent

The interactive checklist for The Witcher 3 Remastered — every point of no return, Ciri's five choices, every kingdom's fate and the Gwent cards you can lose forever.

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BEFORE YOU RIDE OUT

How to use this guide

The Witcher 3 is generous — until it isn't. A handful of story moments quietly close whole questlines, lock endings and remove Gwent cards for good. This guide shows you exactly where those moments are, so you can explore freely and never lose 100 hours of choices to one boat ride.

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THE GOLDEN RULE

When the game offers you a boat to the **Isle of Mists**, stop. Make a separate save, open page 5, and tick every box first.

SPOILER LEVEL

Pages 3–6 and 9–11 are light on spoilers. Pages 7–8 talk about endings — read them when you reach Kaer Morhen, or before your first run if you don't mind.

INTERACTIVE CHECKLIST

Tap any box to tick it — works in Adobe Acrobat Reader, Chrome, Edge and most phone PDF apps. Save the file to keep your progress. Prefer paper? Just print it.

CHAPTER I

The Three Points of No Return

Almost everything in the game waits for you. These moments do not.

#	MOMENT	WHAT IT CLOSES
1	**Leaving White Orchard** Riding with the Nilfgaardian escort to the Emperor	Every open White Orchard side quest, contract and Gwent game.
2	**Sailing to the Isle of Mists** Main quest ***The Isle of Mists***	The biggest cutoff in the game. Around **19 side quests** auto-fail, including Keira Metz's whole arc, the Triss romance, the quests that later unlock the plot against Radovid, and your last chance to recruit allies for Kaer Morhen.
3	**DLC one-way doors** Hearts of Stone auction · Blood and Wine fairy-tale land	In Hearts of Stone, the auction and a later main quest each close a side quest (page 10). The Land of a Thousand Fables is visited only once — explore it fully before you leave.

> ALSO WATCH OUT FOR
>
> Some characters die or leave as the story moves on. Play them at **Gwent** and finish their errands while you can — and see page 9 for the seven cards with no second chance.

Save habits that save runs

- [ ] Hard save before every main quest marked with a boat, a portal or a "this will take you away" warning.
- [ ] Keep one save per region: *White Orchard · Velen · Novigrad · Skellige · Kaer Morhen*.
- [ ] Before the Isle of Mists, make a manual save and **never overwrite it** — you'll thank yourself.

CHAPTER II · POINT OF NO RETURN #1

White Orchard Checklist

The tutorial region is small, but everything here closes when you ride out to meet the Emperor.

Side quests & contracts

- [ ] Missing in Action
- [ ] On Death's Bed
- [ ] Precious Cargo
- [ ] A Frying Pan, Spick and Span
- [ ] Twisted Firestarter
- [ ] Temerian Valuables
- [ ] Contract: Devil by the Well

Before you leave

- [ ] Play the innkeeper at Gwent and buy the cards on offer.
- [ ] Read every notice board in the village.
- [ ] Clear the "?" markers — easy early loot and XP.
- [ ] Unlock every signpost (fast travel).
- [ ] Visit the Places of Power you find — free skill points.
- [ ] Check your inventory: sell junk, keep crafting diagrams.

> **DON'T LOOK FOR IT NOW**
>
> ***Faithful Friend*** is the one White Orchard quest that doesn't fail when you leave — but it only appears in the epilogue of the Empress ending.

CHAPTER III · POINT OF NO RETURN #2

The Big One — Before the Isle of Mists

*Finish these before you board the boat in the main quest **The Isle of Mists**. Anything unfinished here fails automatically.*

Keira Metz (Velen)

- [ ] Magic Lamp
- [ ] A Towerful of Mice
- [ ] A Favor for a Friend
- [ ] For the Advancement of Learning
  Send her to **Kaer Morhen** at the end to recruit her.

Triss & Novigrad

- [ ] A Matter of Life and Death
  At the masquerade, beat all three Gwent players — their cards can't be won anywhere else.
- [ ] Now or Never
  Your choices here decide the Triss romance and whether Radovid can later be stopped.
- [ ] Pyres of Novigrad
  Finish the whole chain to spare Novigrad's mages and non-humans.
- [ ] Carnal Sins
  The Novigrad murder mystery.
- [ ] High Stakes
  The Gwent tournament at the Passiflora.

Roche, Dijkstra & Radovid

- [ ] An Eye for an Eye
  Needed for Roche & Ves to join you at Kaer Morhen.
- [ ] The plot against Radovid (later, in Act III)
  It needs ***A Matter of Life and Death*** and ***Now or Never*** done **now**. Skip them and ***Reason of State*** never unlocks (details on page 8).

Skellige's throne

- [ ] Possession
- [ ] The Lord of Undvik
- [ ] King's Gambit
  Picks Skellige's ruler and recruits Hjalmar.

Allies

- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Velen
- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Novigrad
- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Skellige
- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Nilfgaard

CHAPTER IV

Allies for the Battle of Kaer Morhen

*The more friends you bring, the better the battle goes. Recruiting all of them below (except the bonus) unlocks the **Full Crew** achievement / trophy.*

	ALLY	HOW TO RECRUIT
☐	**Keira Metz**	Complete all her side quests. In the last one, ***For the Advancement of Learning***, send her to Kaer Morhen.
☐	**Triss**	Complete her questline up to ***Now or Never***. Romance isn't required — she comes whether she stays or sails away.
☐	**Roche & Ves**	Complete ***An Eye for an Eye***, then talk to Roche during ***Brothers in Arms: Novigrad***.
☐	**Zoltan**	Talk to him during ***Brothers in Arms: Novigrad***.
☐	**Ermion**	Talk to him during ***Brothers in Arms: Skellige***.
☐	**Hjalmar**	Complete Skellige's succession: ***Possession***, ***The Lord of Undvik***, ***King's Gambit***.
☐	**Letho** BONUS	Only if you told Voorhis at the start of the game that Letho is alive. Complete ***The Fall of House Reardon*** and ***Ghosts of the Past***, then send him to Kaer Morhen. Not needed for Full Crew.

> **REMEMBER**
>
> Every one of these must be done **before the Isle of Mists**. After that boat, the invitation list is closed.

CHAPTER V · SPOILERS

Ciri's Fate — The Five Moments

The game quietly scores how you treat Ciri in five moments across three late quests. The tally, plus one political condition, decides her ending.

	QUEST	POSITIVE CHOICE
☐	***Blood on the Battlefield***	Cheer her up with the **snowball fight** (***"Think I know what might lift your spirits."***).
☐	***Blood on the Battlefield*** **only if you visit Emhyr**	**Refuse the Emperor's payment.** Accepting it counts against you.
☐	***Final Preparations***	Let Ciri **speak to the Lodge of Sorceresses alone**.
☐	***Child of the Elder Blood***	When she loses her temper in Avallac'h's laboratory, say ***"Go for it."***
☐	***Child of the Elder Blood***	Go with her to **Skjall's grave** (***"Yeah. I'll go with you."***).

The three endings

WITCHER CIRI

At least **3 positive** moments, and **don't take Ciri to see Emhyr**. The most popular "best" ending.

EMPRESS CIRI

At least **3 positive** moments, **take her to Emhyr**, and make sure **Nilfgaard wins the war** (page 8 — Roche's side of ***Reason of State***).

THE BAD ENDING

Fewer than 3 positive moments leads to the saddest ending. Accepting Emhyr's coin is the most common way players lose a point without noticing.

TIP

If you skip the Emhyr visit, only four moments are scored — so three of four must be positive.

CHAPTER VI · SPOILERS

The Fate of Kingdoms

The epilogue slides show what became of the North and the Isles. Here's what decides them.

The North: Redania, Nilfgaard & Temeria

	OUTCOME	HOW
☐	**Radovid rules, Nilfgaard loses**	Ignore Triss's ***Now or Never***, so ***Reason of State*** never happens.
☐	**Dijkstra rules Redania**	Help kill Radovid in ***Reason of State***, then **don't interfere** when Dijkstra turns on Roche, Ves and Thaler.
☐	**Nilfgaard wins, Temeria restored**	Help kill Radovid, then **side with Roche and kill Dijkstra**. Temeria becomes a vassal state. Required for the Empress ending.

Skellige

	RULER	HOW
☐	**Cerys an Craite**	Complete ***King's Gambit*** and **side with Cerys**. Peace and prosperity for the Isles.
☐	**Hjalmar an Craite**	Complete ***King's Gambit*** and **side with Hjalmar**. The raids on the mainland continue.
☐	**Svanrige (default)**	Help neither Cerys nor Hjalmar in ***King's Gambit*** (or skip it).

HOW TO UNLOCK REASON OF STATE

1) Finish ***A Deadly Plot*** (it needs ***A Matter of Life and Death*** and ***Now or Never***). 2) In the main quest ***Blindingly Obvious***, **pay Dijkstra with information about the Emperor** — don't fight him (***"Tell you what the emperor's after if you let us go."***). 3) Complete ***Reason of State*** before ***On Thin Ice*** — it fails after that.

PLAN YOUR WHOLE RUN IN ONE LINE

Want Empress Ciri? You need **Now or Never → A Deadly Plot → Blindingly Obvious (info to Dijkstra) → Reason of State (kill Radovid) → side with Roche** plus the Emhyr visit and 3 good moments with Ciri. Want Witcher Ciri? Skip Emhyr, keep 3 good moments — politics are free.

CHAPTER VII

Gwent — Cards You Can Lose Forever

*The quest **Collect 'Em All** asks for 120 unique cards, and the game never tells you which ones you're missing. Patches added backups for many cards — but not for the seven on the right.*

Card rules of thumb

- [ ] Play every named Gwent player the moment you meet them.
  It's the safest habit — and needed for the card collection anyway.
- [ ] Buy out merchant decks in Velen and Novigrad early.
  Cheaper and easier than hunting them later.
- [ ] Play the innkeepers in every region.
- [ ] Finish all Gwent side quests before the Isle of Mists.

7 cards with no second chance

- [ ] A Matter of Life and Death
  Masquerade: win **Milva**, **Vampire: Bruxa** and **Dandelion** from the three players.
- [ ] High Stakes
  Win **all four matches** for the four leader cards (Foltest, Emhyr, Francesca, Eredin). Don't leave the Passiflora mid-tournament — the quest fails.

Gwent tracker

	REGION	OPPONENTS BEATEN	MERCHANTS BOUGHT OUT
☐	White Orchard		
☐	Velen		
☐	Novigrad & Oxenfurt		
☐	Skellige		
☐	Kaer Morhen		

CHAPTER VIII · POINT OF NO RETURN #3

Hearts of Stone & Blood and Wine

Both expansions have their own one-way doors. They're easy to miss because the game doesn't warn you.

Hearts of Stone

- [ ] At the auction in ***Open Sesame!*** buy **every lot**.
  It's the only way to unlock the side quest ***Avid Collector***.
- [ ] Finish ***A Midnight Clear*** before completing ***Dead Man's Party***.
  It fails automatically after that quest.
- [ ] Collect your runewright upgrades as you go.
- [ ] Make a save before the final choice with Gaunter O'Dimm.

Blood and Wine

- [ ] Explore the **Land of a Thousand Fables** completely.
  You only visit it once. Finish the side quest ***Duck, Duck, Goosed*** and pick up everything before the story pulls you out.
- [ ] Upgrade Corvo Bianco, your vineyard, as coin allows.
- [ ] Collect the Grandmaster witcher gear diagrams.
- [ ] Save before the final act — your choices decide the ending in Toussaint.

> **WHEN TO START THE DLCS**
>
> Hearts of Stone is built for a level 30+ Geralt; Blood and Wine for level 34+. Most players do them after the main story's epilogue — the game lets you keep playing after the credits.

CHAPTER IX

New in Remastered

The September 2026 Remastered update is free for existing owners on PC, PS5, Xbox Series X|S and Switch 2. The announced changes are about visuals, skills and gear — not the story, quests or endings, so every checklist in this guide applies.

SKILL TREE REWORK

Skills now sit in a tree with three ranks each, and some need prerequisites before they unlock. **Old build guides are out of date** — respec and experiment.

REFORGING

Change how your gear *looks* without changing its stats. Visit the master craftsmen **Yoana** or **Hattori**.

ALSO NEW

Upgraded textures, lighting and animations, improved combat, an expanded Photo Mode, new accessibility options and cross-platform mod support.

Recommended Order

	#	WHERE	BEFORE MOVING ON
☐	1	**White Orchard**	Page 4 checklist
☐	2	**Velen**	Keira's quests, the Bloody Baron, Velen Gwent
☐	3	**Novigrad**	Triss, Roche, Carnal Sins, Pyres of Novigrad
☐	4	**Skellige**	The succession quests
☐	5	**Isle of Mists**	Everything on pages 5–6 ticked
☐	6	**Kaer Morhen & final acts**	Page 7 — Ciri's five moments
☐	7	**Hearts of Stone**	Page 10
☐	8	**Blood and Wine**	Page 10

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